MODULE 27 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

The Sequences the Exam Tests

Every sequence in the course on a few pages, the two rules, and a method for ordering, "before" and "first" questions.

DOMAIN All EXAM WEIGHT 23% of items MODULE 27 of 33

admin@sthithapragna.com

Almost every sequence **frames first** and **records last**.

Three ways the exam asks about order

ITEM TYPE	SHARE OF THE BANK	WHAT IT ASKS
Put five steps in order	10%	The full sequence, as a five-number option
Which step comes first	7%	The opening step only
Which two come before X	6%	The inputs a step depends on

ON THE EXAM

Twenty-three per cent of items. Knowing the order of things is worth more than any single product fact.

The master shape, from module one

01
Frame
Purpose, audience, criteria, impact.

02
Prepare
Gather, label, classify.

03
Do
Draft, extract, run, design.

04
Check
Against criteria and sources.

05
Decide
Keep, revise, escalate, roll out.

06
Record
The decision, and the lesson.

THE TIEBREAKER

Nearly every sequence in the course is this shape, with different words.

The two rules

- **Rule one: frame before you act.** Purpose, audience, criteria or impact always come before drafting, sending or building.
- **Rule two: document twice.** Document findings before you decide; document the decision after you decide.
- **So "document" has two positions.** Read which kind it is: gaps and findings, or the decision itself.
- **And checking comes before deciding.** You cannot decide on something you have not checked.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Frame first. Findings before the decision; the decision recorded after it.

Prompting and evaluation sequences

SEQUENCE	ORDER	MODULE
Vague request to clear prompt	Task, reader, material, shape, submit and check	03
Decomposition	Objective, phases, steps, detail	04
Iteration	Describe, generate, compare, diagnose, change one thing	05
Evaluation	Criteria, read end to end, compare, document gaps, decide	06
Fact-checking	Read, list claims, cross-check, document, decide	08
Escalation	Audience and impact, risk, criteria, decide, record	09

THE SIGNAL

Domains 1 and 2: criteria before reading, gaps documented before the decision.

Selection and workflow sequences

SEQUENCE	ORDER	MODULE
Model for recurring work	Define the need, candidates, test, compare, decide and monitor	12
Handover to a fresh chat	Summarise, decide what persists, move it, start fresh, check	13
Requirements	Label sources, extract, group and flag, validate, document	14
Process optimisation	Map, measure, bottleneck, options, pilot, decide	15
Integration	Document, value and hand-offs, design, pilot, roll out	16
Stakeholder message	Identify groups, fix the facts, draft, check, deliver	17

THE SIGNAL

Domains 3 and 4: measure or define before you choose; pilot before you roll out.

Configuration and governance sequences

SEQUENCE	ORDER	MODULE
Setting up a Project	Purpose and users, tasks, instructions and knowledge, test, share	18
Writing instructions	Purpose and boundaries, role, standards, conditional rules, test	19
Before data goes to Claude	Classify, check policy, minimise, de-identify, prompt	22
Use-case assessment	Define, test, check policy, decide the role, record	21
Incidents	Contain, report, investigate, fix the cause, share	23
Ethics review	Audience and impact, risks, transparency, revise or escalate, document	24

THE SIGNAL

Domains 5 and 6: purpose or classification first; test before sharing; contain before anything else.

Research and troubleshooting sequences

SEQUENCE	ORDER	MODULE
Research	Frame, scope, gather, rate, verify, summarise	15
Planning	Objective, phases, tasks, risks, people commit	15
Diagnosis	Name it, compare, hypothesise, change one thing, observe and record	25
Feedback cycle	Capture, translate, run, compare, document, decide	26
Maintenance	Own it, watch, diagnose, update, re-test	20

THE SIGNAL

Domain 7: diagnose before you change; compare before you decide.

Solving an ordering question

01

Anchor the first

Find the framing step.

02

Anchor the last

Record, roll out, share or decide.

03

Eliminate

Options that break either anchor.

04

Test one dependency

"What does this step need?"

05

Read it back

Does each step have its inputs?

ON THE EXAM

Anchors first. Most options fall before you think about the middle.

"First" and "before" questions

- **"Which step comes first?"** Pick the framing step. Never draft, send, build or roll out.
- **"Which two come before X?"** Ask what X needs as inputs. Those are the answers.
- **Distractors come from after X:** recording, sharing and rolling out are the usual decoys.
- **The tempting wrong first step** is the most important-sounding one, not the earliest.

> THE TIEBREAKER
>
> "First" means earliest, not most important.

Words that signal the start, middle and end

POSITION	TYPICAL VERBS
Start	Define, identify, clarify, agree criteria, classify, name, map, frame
Middle	Gather, extract, draft, test, compare, measure, verify
End	Decide, document the decision, roll out, share, record, monitor

THE TIEBREAKER

When stuck, sort the verbs into these three buckets.

Sequence traps

THE TRAP	WHY IT FAILS
Choosing the most important step as first	First means earliest
Acting before framing	Breaks rule one
One fixed position for "document"	Findings come before; the decision after
Deciding before checking	Nothing to decide on yet
Rolling out before a pilot	No evidence, and every failure is public
Testing a design that does not exist yet	Steps without their inputs

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Every trap puts a step before the thing it depends on.

> A Halden HR manager types: "Write something about the new holiday policy."
>
> Before she writes a better prompt, she wants to get the first step right.

What should she do first?

A Ask Claude for three drafts and pick the best one

B Decide the output should be a two-page PDF

C Paste in the policy and ask for a summary

D Identify who will read it, and what they need to do as a result

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should she do first?

A Ask Claude for three drafts and pick the best one

Acting before framing.

B Decide the output should be a two-page PDF

Shape comes after knowing the reader.

C Paste in the policy and ask for a summary

Material without a purpose or reader.

D Identify who will read it, and what they need to do as a result

Frame first: reader and purpose.

THE SIGNAL

First means the framing step: who reads it, and what it is for.

Halden's account manager is evaluating a Claude-drafted quarterly summary before it goes to a client.

(1) Decide whether it can be sent, needs revision, or needs escalating.

(2) Agree the criteria the summary must meet.

(3) Read the draft from start to finish.

(4) Record each gap found against the criteria.

(5) Check the figures and claims against the source data.

What is the correct order?

A 2, 3, 5, 4, 1

B 3, 2, 5, 4, 1

C 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

D 2, 5, 3, 1, 4

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct order?

A 2, 3, 5, 4, 1

Criteria, read, check, record gaps, decide.

B 3, 2, 5, 4, 1

Reads before agreeing what good looks like.

C 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

Records gaps before checking the sources.

D 2, 5, 3, 1, 4

Decides before recording the gaps.

THE SIGNAL

Criteria first, decision last, and findings documented before the decision.

> Halden is bidding to clean a hospital trust's non-clinical buildings. The tender has thirty questions, each scored separately.
>
> The bid writer is about to use Claude to draft the answers.

Which two steps must come before drafting the individual answers? Choose two.

A Assemble the final submission

B Confirm the tender's mandatory requirements and scoring criteria

C Write the covering letter that summarises the bid

D Proofread the whole bid

E Gather the method statements and evidence each answer needs

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two steps must come before drafting the individual answers? Choose two.

A Assemble the final submission

Comes after drafting.

B Confirm the tender's mandatory requirements and scoring criteria

Framing: what the answers must achieve.

C Write the covering letter that summarises the bid

Summarises answers that do not exist yet.

D Proofread the whole bid

Checks a bid that has not been written.

E Gather the method statements and evidence each answer needs

The material each answer needs.

THE SIGNAL

Before drafting: the frame and the inputs. Everything else comes after.

> Halden's customer success team has used a new apology-email template in its Project for a month.
>
> The team lead wants to run its first improvement cycle.

What comes first in the improvement cycle?

A Capture specific feedback from account managers and clients

B Rewrite the template's instructions

C Compare this month's apologies with last month's

D Decide whether to keep the template

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What comes first in the improvement cycle?

A Capture specific feedback from account managers and clients

The cycle starts by capturing feedback.

B Rewrite the template's instructions

A change with no feedback behind it.

C Compare this month's apologies with last month's

Compares before anything has changed.

D Decide whether to keep the template

The decision is the last step.

THE SIGNAL

The feedback cycle starts with capture. The decision is its last step.

Halden's operations manager is putting a maintenance routine around the triage Project.

(1) Re-test with the same sample of tickets.

(2) Name an owner and a review date.

(3) Update the stale item, and log the change with a date.

(4) Spot that coordinators keep correcting the same field.

(5) Check the instructions, knowledge and Skills for the cause.

What is the correct order?

A 4, 2, 5, 3, 1

B 2, 4, 5, 3, 1

C 2, 5, 4, 3, 1

D 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct order?

A 4, 2, 5, 3, 1

Spots a signal before anyone owns the Project.

B 2, 4, 5, 3, 1

Own, watch, diagnose, update, re-test.

C 2, 5, 4, 3, 1

Diagnoses before there is a signal.

D 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

Updates before finding the cause.

THE SIGNAL

Own it, watch, diagnose, update, re-test.

> A Claude-drafted incident report about a water leak at a client office is ready. It promises a repair date and mentions possible damage to client equipment.
>
> The supervisor must decide whether it needs a full review before it goes out.

Which two steps must come before deciding whether it needs a full review? Choose two.

A Send the report to the client

B Record the decision and who made it

C Assess the impact on the client, including any commitments the report makes

D Rewrite the report from scratch

E Check the report's facts against the site logs

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which two steps must come before deciding whether it needs a full review? Choose two.

A Send the report to the client

Comes after the decision.

B Record the decision and who made it

Recorded after deciding.

C Assess the impact on the client, including any commitments the report makes

Impact and commitments: the framing input.

D Rewrite the report from scratch

Acts before deciding anything.

E Check the report's facts against the site logs

The check the decision rests on.

THE SIGNAL

Before the escalation decision: impact, and a check against the facts.

> Halden's marketing manager wants Claude to analyse a spreadsheet of client survey responses. It includes respondents' names and work email addresses.

What should she do first?

A Delete the name and email columns

B Upload the spreadsheet to the marketing Project

C Classify the data, and check what the policy allows for that class

D Replace the names with codes

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should she do first?

A Delete the name and email columns

Minimising comes after classifying.

B Upload the spreadsheet to the marketing Project

Uploads before any check.

C Classify the data, and check what the policy allows for that class

Classify first; the policy check depends on it.

D Replace the names with codes

De-identifying comes after minimising.

THE SIGNAL

Data sequences open with classification.

Halden's operations director is using Claude to research whether to trial robotic floor cleaners.

(1) Summarise the findings for the board, stating the gaps.

(2) Write down the decision the research serves, and the questions.

(3) Gather material with Research and Halden's own documents.

(4) Rate each finding's source and confidence.

(5) Verify the claims the decision rests on.

What is the correct order?

A 3, 2, 4, 5, 1

B 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

C 2, 3, 5, 4, 1

D 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the correct order?

A 3, 2, 4, 5, 1

Gathers before framing the question.

B 2, 4, 3, 5, 1

Rates findings that have not been gathered.

C 2, 3, 5, 4, 1

Verifies before knowing which claims are weak.

D 2, 3, 4, 5, 1

Frame, gather, rate, verify, summarise.

THE SIGNAL

Frame, gather, rate, verify, summarise.

admin@sthithapragna.com

In five lines

- **Twenty-three per cent of items** test order, "before" or "first".
- **The master shape:** frame, prepare, do, check, decide, record.
- **Rule one:** frame before you act. **Rule two:** findings before the decision; the decision recorded after.
- **Ordering items:** anchor first and last, eliminate, test one dependency, read it back.
- **"First" means earliest;** "before X" means X's inputs.

> COMING UP
>
> Next: the confusion pairs, side by side.